Minutes of the
General Government Committee Meeting
Held in the Council Chambers, Ajax Town Hall and Electronically
At 1:00 p.m. on October 10, 2023

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

Present:	Chair – Regional Councillor	S. Lee
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		L. Bower
		N. Henry
Regrets:	Mayor	S. Collier

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Chair Lee called the meeting to order at 1:01 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interests.

3. Adoption of Minutes

3.1 Regular Meeting

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

That the Minutes of the regular meeting of the General Government Committee held on September 11, 2023 be adopted.

CARRIED

4. Consent Agenda

Members separated items 4.1 and 4.2 for discussion.

4.1 FIN-2023-24: 2023 Development Charge Background Study Update

Committee Members asked questions regarding financial implications specifically related

to funding of the future phase-in discount, affordable housing and attainable housing defined, and development charges within Community Improvement Plan (CIP) areas. Dianne Valentim, Director of Finance/Treasurer, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the 2023 Development Charge Background Study Update report be received for information.

CARRIED

4.2 **APL-2023-03: 2022 Library Reserve Balances**

Committee Members asked questions regarding additional security costs and budget impacts. Sarah Vaisler, Chief Librarian and Executive Officer, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: L. Bower

1. That this report be received for information.

CARRIED

5. Discussion

None

6. Presentations

6.1 **PDS-2023-34: Street Naming By-law Update – Phase 1: Background**

Joyce Chen, Planner, reviewed the contents of the written report and recommendations contained therein. J. Chen discussed the street naming by-law update process, Ajax street naming history, Ajax street naming conventions, proposed street naming options namely options to remain status quo, expand Veteran street naming, expand the by-law to include indigenous and cultural significance street naming, adopt hybrid ceremonial street naming or adopt hybrid commemorative naming, public consultation, street addressing by-law updates, and next steps.

Committee Members asked questions regarding the hybrid commemorative naming option, public consultation strategies particularly provisions to ensure feedback is gathered from Ajax residents, and opportunities to adopt a hybrid of the proposed options. J. Chen responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: L. Bower

1. That report PDS-2023-34, entitled “Street Naming By-law Update – Phase 1: Background”, dated October 10, 2023, be received for information; and

2. That staff be directed to proceed with consultation on the proposed street naming options as outlined within this report.

CARRIED

6.2 **Waterfront Erosion EA Update (TRCA)**

Stephen Ruddy, Manager of Development Engineering, provided a brief verbal update regarding the waterfront environmental assessment with respect to erosion along the Lake Ontario waterfront. S. Ruddy noted that high water levels, and wind and wave action have caused several sections of the waterfront trail to erode into the lake impacting infrastructure. S. Ruddy introduced Natasha Gibson, Senior Project Manager, Erosion Risk Management, Toronto Region Conservation Authority (TRCA).

N. Gibson delivered a presentation regarding Ajax Waterfront Erosion Mitigation Project Class Environmental Assessment. N. Gison discussed project background, existing conditions, environmental assessment process, concept design options, revised recommendations by Reach, reach location and priority, and next steps.

Committee Members asked questions regarding jurisdictional boundaries, breakwater construction, opportunities to utilize a cobble beach at Rotary Park, shoreline restoration techniques, beach raking, erosion protection timelines, shoreline erosion impacts, project timelines and costs, and public consultation framework, and Reach priority. N. Gibson and S. Ruddy, responded to questions from Committee Members.

There was no motion regarding this item.

6.3 **Strong Mayor Powers**

Jason McWilliam, Manager of Legislative Services/Deputy Clerk, delivered a presentation regarding Strong Mayor Powers legislation. J. McWilliam discussed legislative and regulatory context, provincial priorities (O. Reg 580/22), new Mayoral powers namely directions to staff, legislative powers, administrative and political structure powers and budget powers, exercise of municipal powers, and Mayoral vacancies.

Committee Members asked questions regarding in-year budget amendments and supplementary levy requirements, budget approval process, Councillor vacancy procedures, rationale for the expansion of Strong Mayor Powers to additional municipalities including Town of Ajax, budget process, Mayoral vacancies, provincial priorities, delegated authority to exercise employment powers, requirements to provide notice to Council (as a stakeholder), process to adopt budget amendments, veto powers and veto amendments, and public notice requirements related to provincial priorities. J. McWilliam, D. Valentim, and Shane Baker, Chief Administrative Officer, responded to questions from Committee Members.

There was no motion regarding this item.

7. **Closed Session**

None

8. Adjournment (2:49 p.m.)

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

That the October 10, 2023 meeting of the General Government Committee be adjourned.

CARRIED